

Getting Info about Commands

Brush up on how to get information about bash commands via command line.

man

Definition:

man is used to format or display the *manual pages*. Manual pages or *man pages* are the official documentation of all shell commands that comes along with the Linux distributions.

Syntax:

```
man [option(s)] keyword(s)
```

In order to display manual page from specific section:

```
man [section-num] [command/tool name]
```

Section Numbers:

Section No.	Section Description
1	Programs or shell commands
2	System calls (functions provided by the kernel)
3	Library calls (functions within program libraries)
4	Special files (usually found in /dev)
5	File formats and conventions eg /etc/passwd
6	Games and demonstrations

Section No.	Section Description
7	Miscellaneous (including macro packages and conventions), e.g., man, groff
8	System administration commands (usually only for root)
9	Device driver interfaces

Options:

Option	Syntax	Meaning
-s	<code>man <section num> <command></code>	To specifically view a section of a man page.
-a	<code>man -a <command></code>	To display all manual pages where a command exists.
-w	<code>man -w [command/tool name]</code>	To view the location for man pages.
-I	<code>man -I [command/tool name]</code>	To enable case-sensitivity while searching for man pages
-H	<code>man -H[browser-com- mand] [command/tool name]</code>	To display manual pages in web browser.
-f	<code>man -f [command/tool name]</code>	To lookup for manual pages and display short descriptions as well.

Example:

To get information about the `ls` command:

```
man ls
```

```
man ls
```



Run

Save

Reset



To display section 3 of command `printf`:



```
man 3 printf
```

```
1 man 3 printf
```



Run

Save

Reset



To look in section 1 to find a manual page called `intro`:

```
man -s 1 intro
```

```
man -s 1 intro
```



Run

Save

Reset



To display all entries of `intro` with section numbers and short descriptions:

```
man -f intro
```

```
1 man -f intro
```



Run

Save

Reset



Exit

To quit displaying the man page and return to the command prompt, press `q`.